INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PACKAGING AND PACKING OF LATERAL FILING CABINETS, STEEL, GENERAL OFFICE

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Washington, DC 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers the packaging, packing, material handling provision, and marking requirements of steel lateral filing cabinets as covered by AA-C-1779 (see 6.1).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

L-P-378	-	Plastic Sheet and Strip, Thin Gauge, Polyolefin.
NN-P-71	-	Pallets, Material Handling, Wood, Stringer Construction, 2-Way and 4-Way (Partial).
QQ-S-781	-	Strapping, Steel, Flat and Round.
PPP-B-601	-	Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-640	-	Boxes, Fiberboard, Corrugated, Triple-Wall.
PPP-F-320	-	Fiberboard, Corrugated and Solid, Sheet Stock and Cut Shapes.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

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Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-731 - Quality of Wood Members for Containers and Pallets.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent.

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials. Materials used in the packaging packing palletization, and marking of the lateral filing cabinets shall be as specified herein and in the applicable specifications.

3.1.1 Polyethylene film. The polyethylene film used herein shall conform to L-P-378, type I, grade A, finish 1. The minimum thickness shall be 1.25 mils unless otherwise specified herein.

3.1.2 Fiberboard. The fiberboard material used herein shall conform to PPP-F-320, type CF, class domestic, variety DN. The minimum grade shall be 200 unless otherwise specified herein.

3.1.3 Lumber. All lumber used in the construction of the base frame and the wood skid base herein shall conform to MIL-STD-731, class 2, group I, II, or III wood.

3.1.4 Steel strapping. The steel strapping used as specified herein shall conform with QQ-S-781, class 1, type I or IV regular duty finish A. The size of the strapping shall be as specified herein.

3.2 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

3.2.1 Levels A and B.

3.2.1.1 Each filing cabinet shall be wiped clean prior to packaging and have all leg glides set at their lowest position. Internal parts such as filing drawers and shelves, dividers, hanging folder frames and follower blocks that can come loose in handling and transit shall be secured in place with tape, fiberboard forms, packing clips or other suitable means. Alternatively, internal parts that are removed shall be individually wrapped in non-abrasive material, packed in a fiberboard box and secured in a drawer of the unit. Cellulose wadding strips or non-abrasive cushioning pads not less than .125 inch thick shall be used on the top and side edges of each drawer front and the exposed edges of the doors, when applicable, to prevent metal-to-metal contact when closed. When locks are provided, the drawers shall be closed, the unit locked, the keys placed in a kraft paper envelope, a fabric drawstring bag or a bag made of polyethylene film as specified in 3.1.1 - minimum 2 mils thick, and the bag secured in a recessed drawer handle.

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3.2.1.2 Each cabinet top shall be completely covered with a cushioning sheet of non-abrasive material, minimum thickness .045 inch. The sheet shall extend down over the top edges of the cabinet a minimum of 2 inches and be secured by taping the four sides in place. A bag made of polyethylene film as specified in 3.1.1, shall be used to cover each cabinet. Alternatively, the bag cover may be omitted when the inside face of the corner and center pads, as specified in 3.3.2.1.2 and 3.3.2.1.3, are coated with a non-abrasive and non-transferable coating such as Resist-O-Coat, Michalman or equal.

3.2.2 Level C. Each cabinet shall be prepared for packing to insure adequate protection against abrasion and damage during shipment.

3.3 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

3.3.1 Level A. Each filing cabinet packed as specified in 3.2.1, shall be packed in a tight-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-601, overseas type, styles C or I; PPP-B-636, grade V3c, style RSC; or PPP-B-640, class 2. The interior packing shall conform to 3.3.2.1 or 3.3.2.2. The box shall be closed and strapped or reinforced in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

3.3.2 Level B. Each cabinet packaged as specified in 3.2.1 shall be packed in accordance with 3.3.2.1 or 3.3.2.2 at the option of the supplier.

3.3.2.1 Method I. Each cabinet, packaged as specified in 3.2.1, shall be packed in a tight-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, style RSC or IC, type CF, class domestic, variety SW, minimum grade 275. The internal pack shall include the components specified in 3.3.2.1.1 through 3.3.2.1.4 inclusive. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-636.

3.3.2.1.1 Spring pad. A spring pad extending the full inside length and width of the box (-1/8" + 0") shall be positioned on top and bottom of each cabinet (ref. figure A). The spring pad shall be made from material as specified in 3.1.2. The fiberboard forming the spring pad shall have the corrugations parallel to the width of the box, be slit-scored and folded to provide a minimum clearance of 3/4 inch between the cabinet top and the inside box flaps, and the cabinet bottom and the wood base frame. The slit-scored folds shall be not less than 3 inches wide and shall parallel the length of the box.

3.3.2.1.2 Corner pads. "L" shaped corner pads extending the full height of the cabinet shall be used in all four corners of the pack (ref. figure A). The corner pads shall be made from material as specified in 3.1.2. The fiberboard forming the pads shall be slit-scored and folded to provide a minimum inside face width of 2-1/2 inches and a clearance not less than 3/4 inch between the cabinet and the inside walls of the box.

3.3.2.1.3 Center pad. Two center pads extending the full height of the cabinet, shall be used in each cabinet pack (ref. figure A). The center pads shall be made from material as specified in 3.1.2. The fiberboard forming the pad shall be slit-scored and folded to provide a minimum face width of 2-1/2 inches and a clearance not less than 3/4 inch between the cabinet and the inside walls of the box. Each center pad shall be centered between the corner pads of the pack and secured with tape to the inside side panels of the box. Alternatively, the center pads and corner pads as specified in 3.3.2.1.2, made from corrugated, laminated or molded fiberboard, shall be acceptable when the specified minimum dimensions are maintained.

3.3.2.1.4 Base frame. A base frame extending the full inside length and width of the box (-1/4" + 0") shall be used in the bottom of each cabinet pack (ref. figure A). The base frame shall be made from lumber as specified in 3.1.3. The lumber, as a minimum, shall be nominal 1 x 4 inch. The base frame shall consist of two top length runners and three bottom cross tie members with one of the cross members applied at the center of the frame. The cross members shall be clinch-nailed with not less than two nails per joint.

3.3.2.2 Method II. Each cabinet packaged as specified in 3.2.1 shall be packed as specified in 3.3.2.1, except that the base frame specified in 3.3.2.1.4, shall be omitted and replaced with a bottom pad. The bottom pad, made from material as specified in 3.1.2 minimum grade 275, shall extend the full inside length and width of the box (ref. figure B).

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3.3.3 Level C. Each cabinet, packaged as specified in 3.2.2, shall be individually packed in a box that will assure acceptance and safe delivery in compliance with National Motor Freight Classification or the Uniform Freight Classification.

3.4 Material handling provisions. Cabinets packed as specified in 3.3.1 or 3.3.2 shall be shipped on wood runners or palletized in accordance with 3.4.1 or 3.4.2 respectively, when the requirements of the box specification do not provide access for material handling equipment, unless otherwise specified herein.

3.4.1 Wood runners.

3.4.1.1 Cabinet types II, III, and IV. Types II, III, and IV cabinets packed as specified in 3.3.1 or 3.3.2.1 shall have as a minimum two full dimensioned 2 x 4 or 2 x 6 inch rough cut softwood runners attached under each cabinet pack. The length of the wood runners shall be 1/4 inch less than the outside width dimension of the box. One runner at each end of the pack shall be nailed through the bottom of the box into the base frame with a minimum of four 3 inch screw shank nails spaced approximately 6 inches apart (ref. figure A).

3.4.1.2 Type I cabinets. Type I cabinets, 2-tiers high, shall not require wood runners.

3.4.2 Palletization.

3.4.2.1 Cabinet types II, III, and IV - option I. Each cabinet, types II, III, and IV, packed as specified in 3.3.1, 3.3.2.1, or 3.3.2.2 shall be furnished on a wood skid base made from lumber as specified in 3.1.3. The length and width of the skid base shall be equal to the respective outside length and width of the load and shall consist of four 1 x 4 inch nominal lumber - two top and two bottom length deckboards and three 2 x 4 inch cross width stringers. Each packed cabinet shall be secured to the skid base with not less than two steel straps conforming to material as specified in 3.1.4, minimum 1/2" x .020" or 5/8" x .015". Each strap, placed 6 (± 1) inches in from each end of the container, shall be applied around the top, front and back of the cabinet and under the bottom side of the top deckboards of the base skid. Edge protectors shall be used under the straps on the top edges of the container and the straps tensioned to prevent the packed cabinet from shifting on the skid base (ref. figure B).

3.4.2.2 Cabinet types II, III, and IV - option II. Two cabinets, types II, III, and IV, packed as specified in 3.3.1, 3.3.2.1, or 3.3.2.2 shall be palletized front side to front side in their upright position on a pallet conforming to NN-P-71, type I, class 1, except that the pallet shall be constructed with three stringers as shown in figure 1 of NN-P-71; chamfering of the deckboards is not required, there shall only be five top deckboards and three bottom deckboards equally spaced along the length of the stringers, and the width and length of the pallet shall be equal to the respective outside length and width of the load of packed cabinets. The packed cabinets shall be strapped to the pallet with three straps conforming to material as specified in 3.1.4, minimum 1/2 x 0.020 inch or 5/8 x 0.015 inch. One end strap, packed 6 (± 1) inches in from each end of the load, shall be applied around the front, top, and back of the load and under the bottom side of the top deckboards of the pallet. In a similar manner, a third strap shall be applied to the center of the load on one side of and directly adjacent to the middle stringer. Edge protectors shall be used under the straps on the top edges of the load and the straps tensioned to prevent the packed cabinets from shifting on the pallet.

3.4.2.3 Type I cabinets. Type I cabinets, 2-tiers high, shall not require palletization.

3.5 Marking. Marking shall be in accordance with 3.5.1 or 3.5.2, as specified (see 6.2).

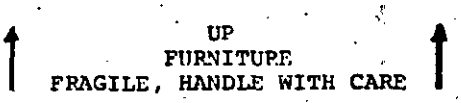
3.5.1 Civil agencies. Each shipping container shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

3.5.2 Military activities. Each shipping container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

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3.5.3 Special marking. In addition to the markings required by 3.5.1 or 3.5.2, each shipping container shall be marked as follows (ref. figure C):

(a) On the side panel:



(b) In an upper corner of both end panels, a standard up arrow.

(c) On the top panel:

TOP
THIS SIDE UP

(d) To facilitate color identification the front and one end panel of each shipping container shall have an area approximately 3 x 8 inches painted to match the color of the unit packed. Alternatively, adhesive-backed color panels of the size specified above shall be applied to the container.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Material inspection. In accordance with 4.1 above, the supplier is responsible for insuring that the packaging and packing materials used are manufactured, tested, and inspected in accordance with the requirements of referenced subsidiary specifications and standards to the extent specified or if none, in accordance with this specification. The supplier shall make available to the inspection team two sets of reference packing assembly drawings along with component packing part drawings to expedite the inspection.

4.2 Sampling for inspection and acceptance. Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.2.1 Inspection of preparation for delivery. An inspection shall be made to determine compliance with the requirements of section 3. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table I. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers offered for acceptance at one time. The inspection level shall be S-4 with an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE I. Classification of defects

Examine	Defects
Marking	Omitted, incorrect wrong location.
Materials	Packing materials not as specified missing, damaged, or non-serviceable.
Workmanship	Straps not properly tensioned. Containers inadequately closed poor application of internal packing parts moveable or loose parts not secured properly.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

This section is not applicable to this specification.

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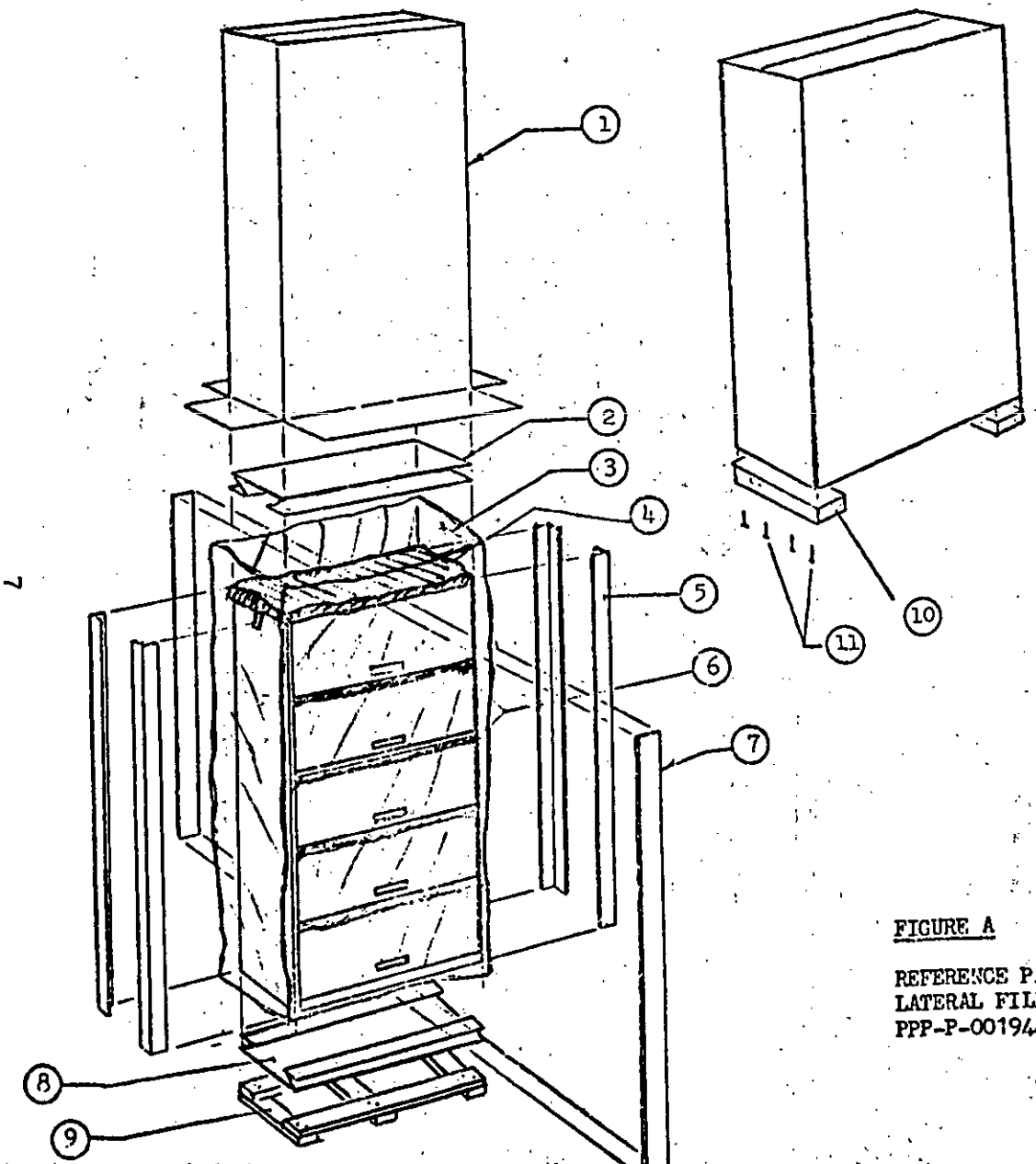
6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The requirements of this specification are intended to be used for the packaging, packing, and marking of steel lateral filing cabinets. Provisions for material handling equipment access and palletization options also form a part of the requirements.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents.

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Packaging level required (see 3.2).
(c) Packing level required (see 3.3).
(d) Type of marking required (see 3.5).

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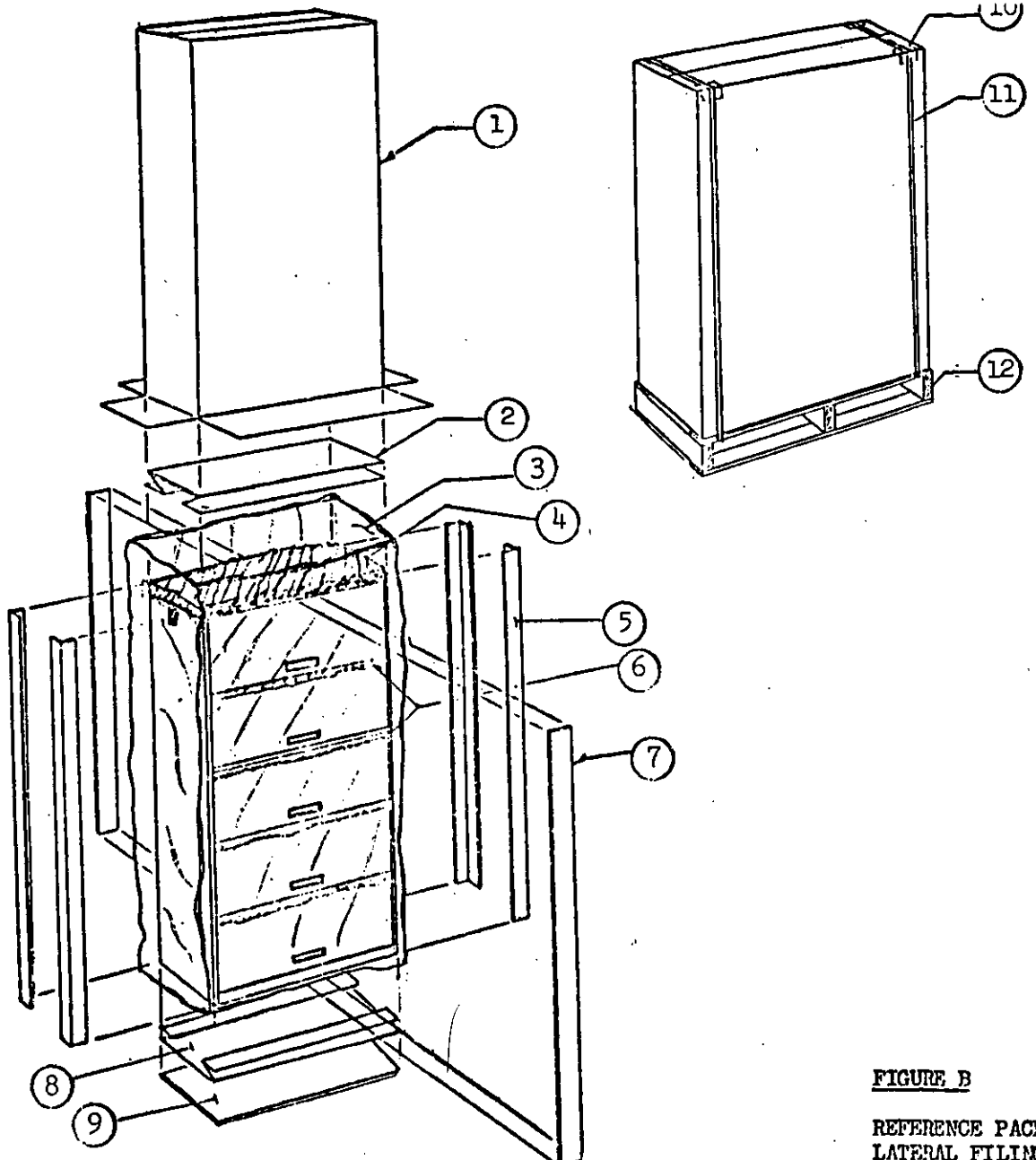


1. Box
2. Spring Pad
3. Bag Cover
4. Top Cushioning Sheet
5. Corner Pads (4 req'd)
6. Cushioning Material
7. Center Pads (2 req'd)
8. Spring Pad
9. Wood Base Frame
10. Wood Runner (2 req'd)
11. Nails

FIGURE A

REFERENCE PACKING ASSEMBLY
LATERAL FILING CABINETS
PPP-P-001944

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1. Box
2. Spring Pad
3. Bag Cover
4. Top Cushioning Sheet
5. Corner Pads (4 req'd)
6. Cushioning Material
7. Center Pads (2 req'd)
8. Spring Pad
9. Bottom Pad
10. Edge Protector
11. Steeling Strapping
12. Skid Base (option I shown)

FIGURE B

REFERENCE PACKING ASSEMBLY
LATERAL FILING CABINETS
PPP-P-001944

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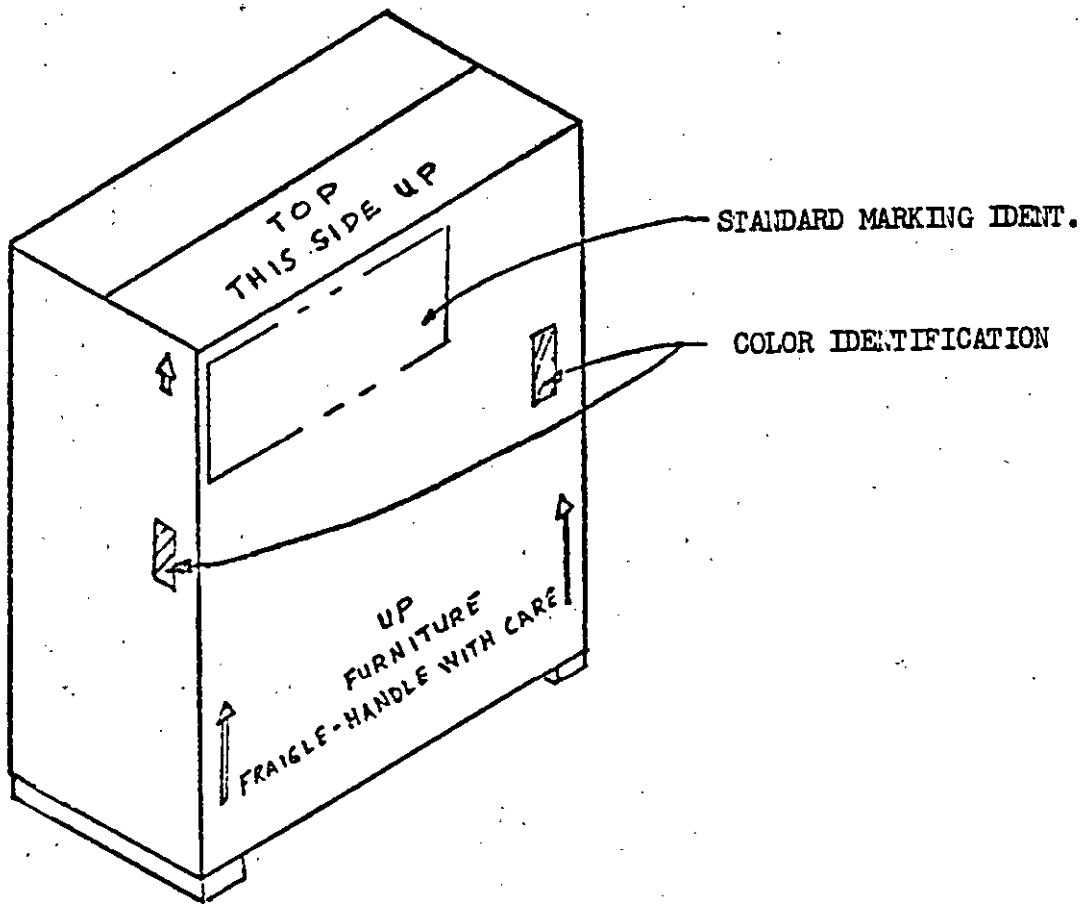


FIGURE C

SPECIAL MARKING

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